

GET WELL SOON

Hi Jane,

Aren't you any better yet? Old Woodsy's more bad-tempered than ever and none of us can get round him. He timed our morning break today- said we were 5 minutes too long. We can't stand it much longer. Get well real soon!!

From all of us at the office (except Grumpy).

- Why do they want Jane to get better quickly?

BIG JESSE

In 1878, the infamous outlaw Jesse James and his gang needlessly engaged in a shootout in Northfield. During a bank holdup the cashier was shot for refusing to open the safe. Alerted, the townsfolk moved to cut off any escape. Although the James brothers made it through the cordon, the Younger brothers were badly wounded. As it transpired, the safe had not been locked.

- Why was the shootout regarded as needless?

NEWS AND GOSSIP

The friends met regularly at Katrina's house to discuss the latest news and gossip. Her mother had given them a pile of snack food to nibble on and they had gone up to her bedroom. Katrina told Shame, her younger sister, to get lost and Celine closed the door.

They were settled in and discussing the new girl in their class when Andie suddenly put her hand to her throat and gasped. She stood up and rushed to the door. As she pulled it open, Shame fell into the room. Andie stepped over her and ran, coughing and spluttering, down the stairs to the kitchen. She gulped down a glass of water and returned to the bedroom.

- What had happened to Andie?

STAMPEDE

The sun rose slowly over the eastern hills. The horses had already started moving, and as the sun warmed their backs, they increased their pace. They were heading to a valley deep in the hills.

The group of backpacking adventure tourists were only just beginning their preparations for the day. A few were emerging from their tents, some still yawning. Others were organising breakfast and talking about the day's activities. They were getting used to these early starts. They spotted the small herd in the distance. Some reached into their packs for their cameras. As they stood peering into the lingering shadows, it became apparent that they were in the path of the now galloping herd.

"Don't worry. They'll go round us," the tour guide assured them. "They never come close to people."

The lead horse, however, headed straight for them, followed closely by his herd. At the last minute the tourists realised they would have to move quickly. Seeming not to notice the surprised people dropping everything and frantically scrambling empty-handed to reach the rocks to get out of their way, the horses galloped through the camp. Behind them, tents were collapsed and breakfast trampled into the ground.

Gathering their scattered belongings, the tourists were grateful that no-one had suffered any injury greater than a grazed knee in their rush to safety.

Recovering quickly, they all agreed that what had just happened was something that money couldn't buy.

- Why were the tourists surprised?
- Do you think they were badly affected by the stampeding horses? Why do you say that?
- Were they upset by the experience? Why do you say that?
- What would be on the photos that they took?

REACTION QUESTION

- If you were one of the tourists would you be upset with the guide? Why do you say that? (Your answer must refer to the text)